CELPIP EXPRESS

Listening Test

STUDY MATERIALS - 7

PART 1

Listening to Problem Solving

Question 1 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- to return her table
- to get a discount on a new table
- to trade her table for a new one
- to follow up on a complaint

Question 2 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- It is easy to assemble.
- It was a good price.
- It is poorly made.
- It was bought in store.

Question 3 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- the woman's husband
- the man at the store
- the woman
- the delivery staff

Question 4 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- interested
- doubtful
- surprised
- regretful

Question 5 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- It can be picked up in the store.
- It offers a cheaper warranty.
- It reduces prices on purchases.
- It provides faster delivery times.

Question 6 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- request her 15% discount
- fill out an online application
- order a replacement card
- put her application in the mail

Question 7 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question

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Question 8 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question

- go to a different store
- purchase the glass table
- purchase the office desk
- ask the man to order a table

PART 2

Listening to a Daily Life Conversation

Question 1 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- to request a parking pass
- to ask for directions to the hotel
- to check into the hotel
- to make a reservation for next week

Question 2 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- to give his children space to play
- to have space for four people
- to have two separate bathrooms
- to keep watch on his children

Question 3 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- a set of rooms with a kitchen
- one large room with room service
- two rooms with a connecting door
- two separate rooms with free internet

Question 4 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- eat dinner in the restaurant
- exercise in the pool
- play free internet games
- rest in their own room

Question 5 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- impressed with the services
- satisfied with the arrangements
- unhappy with the room sizes
- worried that it's too expensive

PART 3

Listening for Information

Question 1 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- public pool
- private pool
- ocean beach club
- lakeside boating club

Question 2 of 6: Choose the best answer

- The swimming lessons are free.
- The lessons fit her schedule.
- She says it's a good time to learn.
- She heard good reviews of their lessons.

Question 3 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- She cannot hold her breath under water.
- She has never taken swimming lessons.
- She can only float in the water.
- She is new to the community.

Question 4 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- to place her in the appropriate class
- to learn more about her physical health
- to discover why she wants lessons
- to find out why she cannot swim

Question 5 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- Her parents passed on their fear of water.
- She had a frightening experience on a boat.
- She saw a child have a swimming accident.
- She once suffered an injury while swimming.

Question 6 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- two mornings a week
- two evenings a week
- three evenings a week
- weekend mornings

PART 4

Listening to a News Item

1. The Kelowna couple were _____
- ◯ cleaning out their attic.
- ◯ moving boxes into the attic.
- ◯ removing a wasp nest.
- ◯ watching the wasps.

2. The surprise they found was _____
- ◯ constructed from old paper.
- ◯ discarded near the nest.
- ◯ owned by a collector.
- ◯ used as a party decoration.

3. While solving the mystery, they discovered _____
- ◯ more wasp nests.
- ◯ some old books.
- ◯ a large pinata.
- ◯ party balloons.

4. The collector _____
- ◯ offered to sell the item.
- ◯ refused to look at the item.
- ◯ wanted to buy the item.
- ◯ gave a value for the item.

5. The couple decided to _____
- ◯ delay renovations to their house.
- ◯ sell the item to pay for renovations.
- ◯ think more about their options.
- ◯ look for more items in their attic.

PART 5

Listening to a Discussion

1. What does the store's collection consist of?
- ◯ largely romance novels
- ◯ various non-fiction books
- ◯ primarily bestselling books
- ◯ numerous book genres

2. How was the book "Love Wins" displayed in the window?
- ◯ Fifty copies of that book only were displayed.
- ◯ The book was displayed only on the top shelf.
- ◯ The book was displayed with other romance titles.
- ◯ Ten copies were displayed with other genre titles.

3. What do Nathan and Tasha agree about?
- ◯ The bookstore is not doing well financially.
- ◯ The storefront window should display one genre at a time.
- ◯ The bookstore is known for its range of titles.
- ◯ The storefront window should not be advertising space.

4. What is Naomi most concerned about?
- ◯ pleasing publishers
- ◯ beautifying the display
- ◯ generating revenue
- ◯ satisfying customers

5. What is Tasha most concerned about?
- ◯ representing the store accurately
- ◯ remaining loyal to customers
- ◯ staying up-to-date on bestsellers
- ◯ designing creative storefront displays

6. What is likely true of the store's staff?
- ◯ They would rather work at another bookstore.
- ◯ They routinely compile customer statistics.
- ◯ They receive sales bonuses from publishers.
- ◯ They have a good relationship with authors.

PART 5

7. What happens at the end of the discussion?

- ◯ They collaborate on a new solution.
- ◯ An agreement is reluctantly made.
- ◯ They postpone their decision.
- ◯ Statistics are used to make a decision.

8. What is the discussion mainly about?

- ◯ advertising opportunities in the store
- ◯ creating an attractive window display
- ◯ methods for attracting new customers
- ◯ appropriate uses of the storefront

PART 6

Listening for Viewpoints

1. What did Moreau conclude about poor school performance?

- ◯ It is worsened by playing violent video games.
- ◯ It is correlated to time spent video game playing.
- ◯ It is caused by frequent unrestricted video gaming.
- ◯ It is improved if students stop playing video games.

2. What can we conclude from Moreau's study on video gaming and aggression?

- ◯ Aggressive traits lead students to play video games.
- ◯ Video gaming and aggressive behaviour are not correlated.
- ◯ What prompts video gaming may also cause aggression.
- ◯ Playing video games makes adults more aggressive.

3. What do both experts agree gaming does?

- ◯ It has unknowable effects.
- ◯ It builds interpersonal skills.
- ◯ It tends to become addictive.
- ◯ It impedes learning outcomes.

4. Which statement would Moreau likely agree with?

- ◯ Teenagers are becoming more self-disciplined in video gaming.
- ◯ More research into children and video gaming is needed.
- ◯ Those over eighteen are less affected by video games.
- ◯ Parents are well informed about the impact of video gaming.

5. What does Hornvelt believe about video gaming?

- ◯ It helps people break the ice and become friends.
- ◯ It strengthens one's ability to self-discipline.
- ◯ It promotes youths' academic performances.
- ◯ It supplies practice in reasoning skills.

6. What advice would Moreau have for the general public?

- ◯ Spend less time playing video games.
- ◯ Try to select less violent video games.
- ◯ Play more educational video games.
- ◯ Don't let your child play video games.

Answer Key

PART 1	
Question 1	to trade her table for a new one
Question 2	It was a good price.
Question 3	the delivery staff
Question 4	interested
Question 5	It reduces prices on purchases.
Question 6	fill out an online application
Question 7	
Question 8	go to a different store

PART 2	
Question 1	to check into the hotel
Question 2	to keep watch on his children
Question 3	a set of rooms with a kitchen
Question 4	exercise in the pool
Question 5	satisfied with the arrangements

PART 3	
Question 1	public pool
Question 2	She says it's a good time to learn.
Question 3	She has never taken swimming lessons.
Question 4	to place her in the appropriate class
Question 5	She had a frightening experience on a boat.
Question 6	two evenings a week

PART 4	
Question 1	cleaning out their attic.
Question 2	constructed from old paper.
Question 3	some old books.
Question 4	gave a value for the item.
Question 5	think more about their options.

PART 5	
Question 1	numerous book genres
Question 2	Fifty copies of that book only were displayed.
Question 3	The storefront window should not be advertising space.
Question 4	generating revenue
Question 5	representing the store accurately
Question 6	They routinely compile customer statistics.
Question 7	An agreement is reluctantly made.
Question 8	appropriate uses of the storefront

PART 6	
Question 1	It is correlated to time spent video game playing.
Question 2	What prompts video gaming may also cause aggression.
Question 3	It tends to become addictive.
Question 4	More research into children and video gaming is needed.
Question 5	It supplies practice in reasoning skills.
Question 6	Spend less time playing video games.

Transcripts

Listening to Problem Solving

You will hear a conversation between a man and a woman at a furniture store. The man works at the furniture store and the woman is a customer.

Section 1:

MAN: Hi, how can I help you?

WOMAN: Hi. I bought a table from your online store last week and it seems like it got a bit damaged during the delivery.

MAN: Ok. Is that the table there?

WOMAN: Yeah. We got a great deal and it's of excellent quality. But when my husband started to assemble it, he noticed the damage. I really like the table, so I'd actually just like to exchange it. Here's a copy of the invoice.

MAN: All right, let's have a look here . . . Hmmm, I can see the scratch on the top. Were you home when it was delivered?

WOMAN: My husband was home, but he only noticed the damage after the truck had left. I tried to do an online return, but the instructions were confusing.

MAN: I'm sorry about that. Let me just open your file on the computer. The system is a little slow, so this might take a moment.

Now answer questions 1-3.

1. Why does the woman go to the store?
2. Which statement is true about the table?
3. Who is likely responsible for the damage to the table?

Section 2:

MAN: Alright. I just need a few more details from you. Did you pay with our store credit card?

WOMAN: No, I paid with my debit card.

MAN: That's too bad. If you'd used our credit card, you could've received a 15% discount. We also offer an extended warranty on all items purchased with this card, which includes free delivery on your replacement table. The standard warranty doesn't cover that.

WOMAN: That sounds great! Can I apply for a store credit card here?

MAN: I'm afraid you can only apply online. When you go to our home page, you'll see an image of a credit card and next to it there's a button that says 'apply'. Just click on that and fill out the details.

WOMAN: All right. How long before the card arrives?

MAN: You'll get it in the mail in about 10 business days.

Now answer questions 4-6.

4. How does the woman feel about the store credit card?
5. What is true about the store credit card?
6. What will the woman likely do about the credit card?

Transcripts

Section 3:

MAN: Okay. I checked and it seems like we don't have the exact same table in stock, my apologies. We have this circular one, which is easy to assemble. Another option is this brown one. It's more of an office desk, but it's solid wood.

WOMAN: The brown one is nice, but it's not really what I need. How much is that glass one?

MAN: It's almost the same price as the one you bought. It's a very popular style.

WOMAN: Yeah, it's pretty nice, but I still prefer the table I got; it's a nice rectangular wooden table with a drawer. I'm going to shop around; if I can't find the one I originally bought anywhere else, I'll come back for this glass one.

MAN: No problem, I will hold it for you until the end of today.

WOMAN: Sounds good. Thank you.

Now answer questions 7-8.

7. Which one does the woman like most?
8. What will the woman likely do next?

Transcripts

Listening to a Daily Life Conversation

You will hear a conversation between a man and a woman at a hotel. The woman works at the hotel, and the man is a customer.

WOMAN: Welcome to the Ocean Breeze Hotel. How may I help you?

MAN: Hi. Can I please get two rooms together for tonight? Side-by-side together with a connecting door. My name's Hank Gruber.

WOMAN: Let me see what we have available. We don't have rooms with connecting doors, but we do have a suite that includes two bedrooms. It also has two bathrooms and a kitchen. That's probably your best bet.

MAN: That might be convenient, but we don't need a kitchen. How much does the suite cost?

WOMAN: It's $350 for one night, plus taxes. I do have two separate rooms on the sixth floor. Each of these rooms would be $150 plus taxes. Would you prefer these?

MAN: Well, the kids are young teenagers, so we want them where we can see them. Would the four of us fit in one of those rooms?

WOMAN: There are two queen-size beds in each room, and the bathroom is quite large. For two additional people it would be $25 extra per person.

MAN: Well, we may as well go for the suite, then. It's not much more, and then we can keep an eye on our kids. What about restaurants? Is there something in the hotel?

WOMAN: We have complimentary breakfast every morning. For dinner this evening, you should try the Breeze Bar and Grill which serves a variety of food, including burgers and fries. I'm sure everyone will find what they like on the menu.

MAN: Oh yeah, that sounds great. What about parking? Oh, and I think you have a pool, right? The kids would love to play around in the pool for a while.

WOMAN: Here's a parking pass to put on your vehicle dashboard. The parking area is behind the hotel. Actually, I'm sorry but the pool is closed this week for repairs. Instead I can provide free movies and internet games on your TV if you like. Your children might like that.

MAN: Well, the pool would tire them out more, but we'll accept your offer anyway. Sign us in for one night in that suite!

Now answer questions 1-5.

1. Why is the man talking to the woman?
2. Why does the man want two rooms together?
3. What kind of room does the woman suggest?
4. What was the man wishing his children could do?
5. How does the man feel about the hotel?

Transcripts

Listening for Information

You are about to hear a conversation between a man and a woman. The man is a lifeguard, and the woman is asking him about swimming lessons.

WOMAN: Hi! I just moved to this neighbourhood and I'm excited that there's a city aquatic centre right here! I've never learned how to swim and I'd like to take lessons.

MAN: Great! My name's Matt. I'm a lifeguard here and I teach swimming lessons! What's your name?

WOMAN: I'm Andrea. Nice to meet you! How do I begin swimming lessons? I'm a bit nervous.

MAN: Nice to meet you too! Don't worry, everyone is nervous at first. What level of class you start in will depend on your comfort level. Let me ask you a few questions. Are you comfortable putting your face under water and holding your breath?

WOMAN: Yes, I'm pretty comfortable doing that. I can hold my breath under water in the bathtub.

MAN: Great! That's a good first step. Can you blow bubbles with your face in the water, without getting water up your nose?

WOMAN: Yes! . . . I can do that.

MAN: Perfect. Are you comfortable floating in water?

WOMAN: No, definitely not. I fell out of a boat when I was a child and was a bit traumatized. That's why I have always been scared of water. But I've always wanted to learn how to swim, and now is as good a time as any to face my fear!

MAN: I agree! Swimming can be really fun if you feel safe in the water. I'm going to recommend you start in Adult Beginner Level One classes. They run on Monday, Wednesday, and Saturday evenings. You can do anywhere from one to three classes a week, for forty-five minutes each. I teach the Saturday evening classes.

WOMAN: I can do Wednesdays and Saturdays, so that works perfectly. What will I need to bring?

MAN: You'll need a swimsuit that you can move comfortably in, a towel, and 25 cents for the lockers in the changeroom. I'd also recommend swim goggles, which we sell here. If you want to protect your hair from the chlorine, we also sell swim-caps.

WOMAN: Great! I don't have a swimsuit yet, but I'll go buy one.

MAN: Excellent! Let's get you signed up for classes!

Now answer questions 1-6.

1. Where do the swimming lessons take place?
2. Why does the woman want to learn to swim?
3. Why is the woman nervous?
4. Why does the man ask the woman so many questions?
5. Why is the woman afraid to swim?
6. When will the woman take classes?

PART 4

Transcripts

Listening to a News Item

You will hear a news story about something surprising found by a couple in Kelowna.

Last Friday night, a Kelowna couple found a surprise while clearing the attic of their heritage house.

Alex and Rebecca Castillo found a paper wasp nest in the attic. The nest was built by stinging insects that chew on wood fibre, mix it with their saliva, and spew out a substance they use as a building material.

But this was no ordinary wasp nest. It was bright red, blue, and yellow, looking more like a pinata or party balloon than a nest. To solve the mystery, the Castillos didn't have to look far. In another room of the attic, they found four dusty boxes of old superhero comic books, which the wasps had used as raw material. Most of the comics had been chewed to shreds, but several were still sealed in their original plastic packaging.

The Castillos brought the unharmed items to a collector's shop and were told that one, a rare 1952 Superman comic in mint condition, is worth $1,600 dollars. Resolved to continue working on their house, the Castillos are now deciding whether to keep the item or sell it on eBay.

Transcripts

Listening to a Discussion

You will watch a discussion among three business associates, two women and one man. They work at a bookstore.

Naomi: So, the first thing on our agenda is the storefront window. The two of you have some concerns?

Nathan: Yes, we've been concerned about the message we're sending. For six of the last eight weeks, we've been featuring a romance title. But we carry many other genres of fiction. We also carry non-fiction.

Tasha: Not only that, but we had fifty copies of the same title in the window. I mean, if we want to feature romance, we should have fifty different titles, one copy of each. Otherwise, it's psychological manipulation.

Naomi: Yes, but the publisher of Love Wins paid us for exclusive use of that window. That's why we displayed only that title.

Nathan: You've been using our window for advertising? Since when?

Tasha: Oh, I don't like that at all! I agree with Nathan. I mean, what's in our window should represent what's on our shelves. Alternatively, we should put all our best books in our window.

Nathan: Isn't it our ultimate goal to stay in business? By attracting new customers? I mean, sure, by increasing advertising on one title we will increase sales of that title, but . . .

Naomi: We need the advertising revenue. It's as simple as that.

Tasha: No, I don't think it is. I mean, if you are selling our store front display to the highest bidder, I'm afraid that we're heading in a really bad direction! People will start thinking of us as the romance bookstore! And they won't think of us when they want to buy literary fiction or nonfiction!

Nathan: We'll start losing customers. And, therefore, we are going to start losing revenue. Couldn't we, say, have three different bookshelf levels in the window? We could have one for literary fiction, one for genre fiction, and on the last one, we could put non-fiction.

Naomi: Why can't we do that? Because no one will pay to have one copy of a book in a window!

Tasha: Yeah, but that's my point. Our storefront window shouldn't be for sale! The people who come to this mall do a lot of window browsing. We should be using it to draw them into the store, by showing them what's inside.

Nathan: Would you be willing to try my idea for two months? Just to compare statistics—we could look at how many people come in, we could look at sales, and so on, and then we could come back and revisit the issue.

Tasha: Keep in mind that we're competing with other bookstores. I mean, there are two others right here in this mall. And people expect the stock in the window to represent the stock in the store.

Naomi: But publishers pay so much money . . . Okay, let's try it. For a couple of months. And then we'll see.

Transcripts

Listening for Viewpoints

You will hear a presentation about video games.

As video gaming rises in popularity, the debate about its benefits and risks rages on. Reviled by some as a cause of poor grades and aggressive behaviour in children, video gaming is now just as likely to be touted as a way to develop important skills and facilitate learning.

Psychologist Thomas Moreau sees a link between lower grades and frequent, unrestricted recreational video gaming. In his study of 1,500 students ages 8 to 18, those who devoted less time to video gaming boasted consistently higher academic achievement. Moreau is quick to add that these findings should be interpreted cautiously, since academic underachievement and the inclination to play video games could both stem from an unknown cause. Moreau applies similar reasoning to his previous research correlating video gaming and aggression. Moreau can't say that one causes the other; both might be attributable to a third factor. Thus, for Moreau it's too soon to say that video games pose a risk to children's thoughts and emotions, but he does note that 85% percent of video games include violence, and children tend to mimic what they see.

Forty-year-old Mike Hornvelt is no child, but he's an avid gamer. A University of Toronto professor specializing in the history of Canadian education, Dr. Hornvelt believes video games teach people how to learn. Hornvelt says video games engage players in a problem-solving cycle. Hypothesis, experimentation, and eventual deduction are involved as players try different options in an effort to solve a challenging problem. Hornvelt says he enjoys collaborative multi-player games, especially entrepreneurial business startup and management simulations, and he insists that they've helped him develop skills such as teamwork, mediation, and self-assessment.

Where Moreau and Hornvelt see eye to eye is the claim that video gaming can become habit forming. Moreau points out that the average North American student plays nearly 10,000 hours of video games by the time they graduate college. Even Hornvelt admits that he himself has fallen prey to the lure of interactive technology. The former compulsive 25-hour-a-week gamer now observes a strict weekly limit: four hours, weekends only.

A similar ability to self-regulate would be hard to find among children, Moreau notes, arguing that it is mostly up to parents to curb or even stop their child's video game playing before it gets out of hand. Children's brains are highly plastic, says Moreau, and excessive game playing at a young age could have lifelong impacts. He recommends that parents not let children under five play video games at all and says a limit of two hours a week is enough for everyone else.